

How use Claude Code to build Apps



Guide written by Nas
Selling with Nas

Most people try to use Claude code by going to the Claude Desktop App, then clicking to the “Code” Tab” and then just typing out their idea. Although this may seem like the silver bullet that builds your app (because yes, the initial demo always looks cool), it’s not actually the best way to create a real App that people can use. Below is a guide on how to actually use Claude Code to build your first app.

What will you need?

To Use Claude Code effectively, you will need 2 things:

1) A Claude Pro Subscription.

Unfortunately, Claude Code is only available under a paid subscriptions



2) Visual Studio Code

You can download it [here](#). It’s free, and don’t worry, you don’t have to write a single line of code. Simply follow this guide.



Are you a more visual person?

If you want to see a video guide on Youtube of how to get started with Claude Code, watch this video::

<https://youtu.be/TWZsx4U3g2E?si=6ylaYxfKsJbyT43Y>



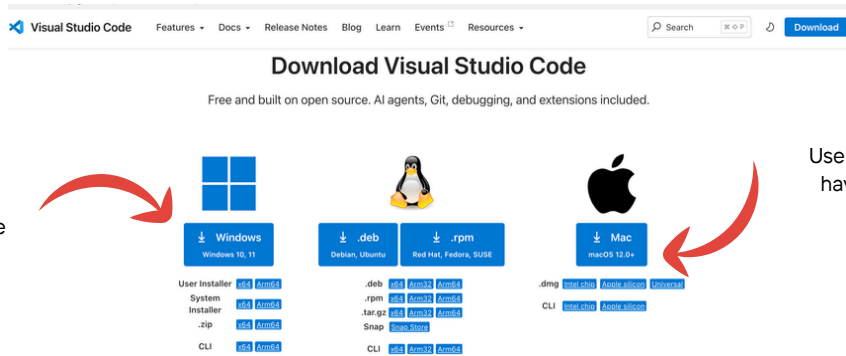
If you want to build your first App with me, you can do so on a 1-on-1 session below.

[Build your first App with me](#)

Step 1) Download Visual Studio Code

Visual Studio Code (also known as VS Code) is a free app to write and manage code. Think of it as Microsoft Word, but for code. The good news? You don’t actually need to know how to code to use it - as long as you pair it with Claude, you can build and manage projects just by describing what you want in plain English. Download it for free at code.visualstudio.com.





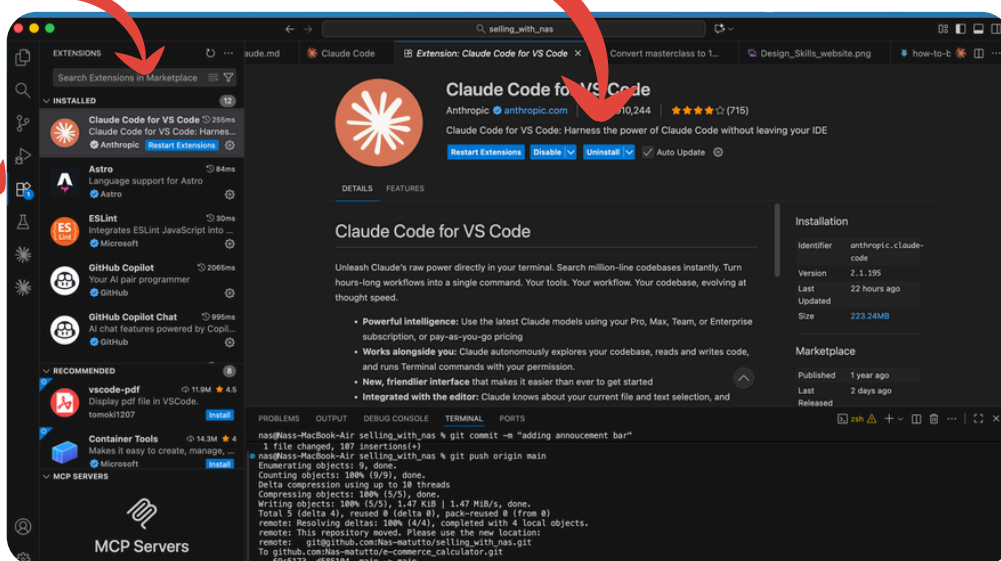
Step 2) Add the Claude Code extension

VS Code on its own is just a blank editor. To bring Claude into it, you need to install the Claude Code extension. Extensions are like apps you add to a browser - they give VS Code new superpowers. To add it, open VS Code, click the Extensions icon on the left sidebar (it looks like four squares), search for "Claude Code," and hit Install. This is what connects Claude's AI brain directly to your coding environment.

Step 3: Click on Install

Step 2: Search for "Claude Code"

Step 1: Click here on Extensions



Want to Master Claude Code with me?

Build your first App with me

Every session is 1-on-1 and personalized to you

More Info:



www.sellingwithnas.com

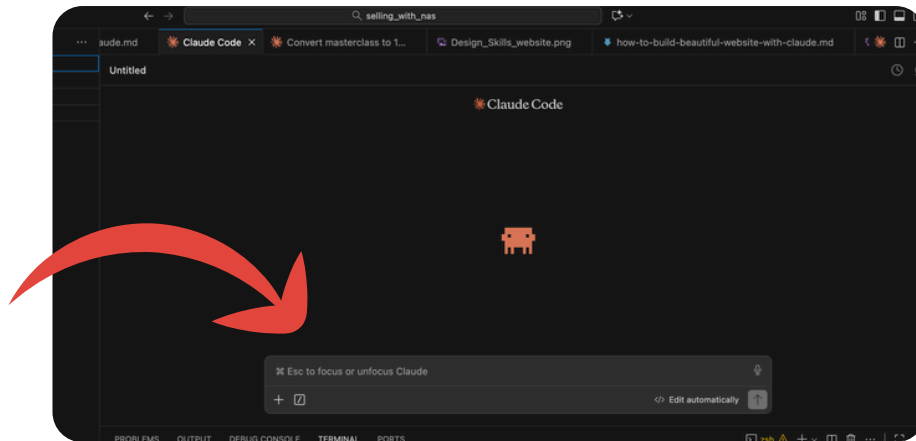


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Step 3) Sign in and open Claude Code

Once the "Claude Code for VS Code" extension is installed, you'll need to sign in with your Anthropic account. To do that, click on the Claude Code panel inside VS Code and follow the login prompts. Important: Claude Code requires a Claude Pro subscription (or above) to use - the free tier won't give you access. If you haven't upgraded yet, head to claude.ai and subscribe before trying to log in. Once signed in, Claude lives right inside your editor and is ready to help you build.

You can prompt your app idea in this box



Want to Master Claude Code with me?

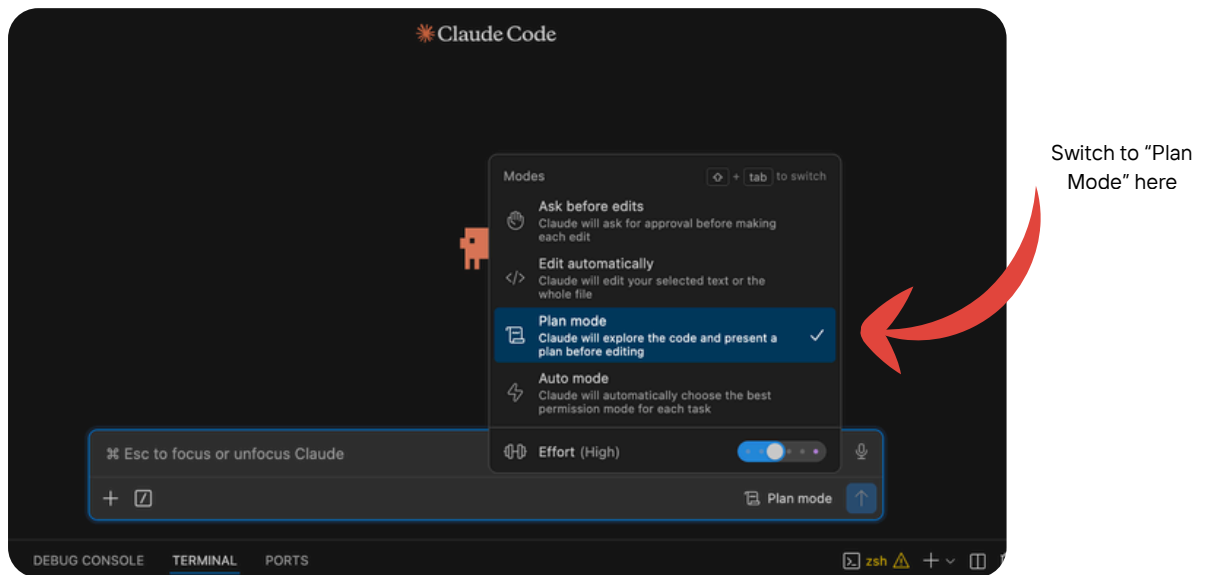
Build an App with me

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Step 4) Always start in Plan Mode

Before you ask Claude to do anything, get into the habit of switching to Plan Mode first. You activate it by pressing Shift + Tab twice, or by clicking where it says "Edit automatically" on the bottom right corner of the Claude prompt box. In Plan Mode, Claude thinks through and asks you a bunch of questions to clarify before it starts building actual code. This is very helpful because you can give Claude recommendations on which development path to follow and avoid bugs down the line.





Step 5) Review the Plan and Accept

Once Claude lays out a plan to build your app, you should review its logic and either accept, or "Accept with changes" - which is an option that allows you to make some tweaks to the logic of it. From this point onwards, Claude will be hard at work creating your MVP.

Step 6) Launch on localhost

When Claude gives you a first version, ask it to launch on localhost - this is a local server that only loads on your laptop and it allows you to see the app before it's live to the public. Once you see it, you can then go back to the Claude Chat and continuously make changes to it by prompting.

If you get to this stage and want to learn how to publish your app to the internet.. I'm here to help!

Book a 1-on-1 session with me

We will go through your app and publish it to the Internet